AI Second Brain - DIY Setup Guide

> ***Package**: DIY Starter ($197 - Self-Service) **Delivery**: Instant ZIP download via email **Timeline**: 3 days to productivity **Support**: Email support (24-48 hour response)*

This guide is for DIY package customers who received `second-brain-latest.zip` via email after purchase.

What You Received

Your DIY Package Includes

Source: `lib/email/templates.ts:121-145` (DIY email template)

✅ **Complete GitHub repository files** (in ZIP) ✅ **10+ pre-configured AI agents** ✅ **10+ automations ready to use** ✅ **Step-by-step setup guide** (this document) ✅ **Profession-specific templates** ✅ **Email support** (iwo.szapar@gmail.com) ✅ **7-day money-back guarantee**

What's NOT included (available in premium packages): ❌ Live 1-on-1 session with Iwo (Kickstart $497 or Done-With-You $1,497) ❌ Personalized repository customization ❌ Guided questionnaire and workflow analysis ❌ Live troubleshooting and screen-share support

Prerequisites (Complete Before Starting)

Required

- [ ] **Claude Pro subscription** ($20/month) - Get at **claude.com/upgrade**
- [ ] **GitHub account** (free) - Sign up at **github.com/signup**
- [ ] **Computer** with internet access
- [ ] **3-4 hours** of focused time for initial setup

Recommended

- [ ] **Basic file management skills** (unzip, copy/paste, drag-and-drop)
- [ ] **Familiarity with GitHub** (creating repos, uploading files)
    - New to GitHub? Watch: **GitHub Basics Tutorial**

Optional

- [ ] Claude Code CLI installed (for terminal users)
- [ ] Node.js 16+ (for advanced MCP integrations)
- [ ] VS Code or Cursor (if you prefer IDE over Claude.ai web)

Quick Start (30 Seconds to First Value)

Step 1: Download Your ZIP

Check your email for:

- **Subject**: "Your Second Brain is Ready!"
- **From**: **iwo.szapar@gmail.com**
- **Attachment**: `second-brain-latest.zip`

Can't find email?

- Check spam/promotions folder
- Search inbox for "second-brain"
- Email **iwo.szapar@gmail.com** with order confirmation

Step 2: Unzip Files

macOS:

- Double-click `second-brain-latest.zip`
- Files extract to `second-brain-latest/` folder

Windows:

- Right-click `second-brain-latest.zip`
- Select "Extract All..."
- Choose destination folder

Step 3: Create GitHub Repository

1. Go to **github.com/new**
2. **Repository name**: `second-brain` (or any name you prefer)
3. **Visibility**: Private (recommended) or Public
4. **Initialize**: Leave ALL checkboxes UNCHECKED
5. Click "Create repository"

Step 4: Upload Files to GitHub

Option A: Web Upload (easiest):

1. On your new repository page, click "uploading an existing file"
2. Drag ALL files from `second-brain-latest/` folder into browser
3. Scroll down, click "Commit changes"
4. Done! Your Second Brain is on GitHub

Option B: Git Command Line (for terminal users):

```
cd second-brain-latest/
git init
git add .
git commit -m "Initial Second Brain setup"
git remote add origin https://github.com/YOUR-USERNAME/second-brain.git
git push -u origin main
```

Step 5: Open in Claude

Option A: Claude.ai Web (recommended for beginners):

1. Go to **claude.ai**
2. Start new chat
3. Click paperclip icon
4. Select "Add project from GitHub"
5. Choose your `second-brain` repository
6. Type: `/start Help me write a follow-up email`

Option B: Claude Code CLI (for terminal users):

1. Clone your repo: `git clone https://github.com/YOUR-USERNAME/second-brain.git`
2. Navigate: `cd second-brain`
3. Open Claude Code: `claude`
4. Type: `/start Help me write a follow-up email`

✅ **Success indicator**: Claude drafts an email using your business context in ~30 seconds!

Day 1: Technical Setup (2 hours)

Configure Your Brain

Run the setup wizard:

```
/setup
```

This 10-minute guided setup asks you:

1. What's your name and role?
2. What do you do?
3. What do you sell/offer?
4. Who's your ideal customer?
5. What makes you different?
6. What tasks do you want help with?
7. What would success look like in 30 days?

What happens:

- Updates `CLAUDE.md` "About Me" section with your info
- Creates `memory/company/products.md`
- Creates `memory/company/differentiators.md`
- Creates `memory/customers/ideal-customer-profile.md`
- Initializes `brain-health/growth-log.md`

Source: `template/.claude/commands/setup.md:1-313`

Personalize CLAUDE.md

Open `CLAUDE.md` and fill in (lines 34-54):

```
## About Me

### Who I Am
- **Name**: [Your Name]
- **Role**: [Your Role/Title]
- **Company**: [Your Company]

### What I Do
[Describe your work in 2-3 sentences]

### My Expertise
- [Expertise area 1]
- [Expertise area 2]
- [Expertise area 3]

### My Goals with This Brain
- [Goal 1 - be specific]
- [Goal 2 - be specific]
```

Why this matters: Claude reads CLAUDE.md at EVERY session start. This is your brain's permanent memory.

Source: `template/CLAUDE.md:34-54`

Test Your First Command

Try `/ask`:

```
/ask "Help me write a follow-up email to a prospect"
```

What happens (Source: `template/.claude/commands/ask.md:14-52`):

1. Claude reads your memory files (company/, customers/, patterns/)
2. Searches for relevant patterns
3. Checks past experiences
4. Generates response using YOUR business context

Time: ~30 seconds

✅ **You've completed Day 1 setup!**

Day 2: Learn the Workflow (2 hours)

The 4-Step Cycle

Source: `template/CLAUDE.md:76-79`

Every task in your Second Brain follows this proven approach:

```
/plan [task]  →  /work [plan]  →  /review [output]  →  /learn
    ↓                ↓                   ↓                  ↓
 Research       Execute with       6-agent            Extract
 + Plan         todo tracking      quality check      patterns
```

Your First Project

Pick a REAL task (small, 30-minute max):

- Write a client follow-up email
- Draft social media post
- Create one-page proposal
- Summarize meeting notes

Run the complete cycle:

Step 1: Plan

```
/plan Write follow-up email to [Client Name] after demo call
```

What happens (Source: `template/.claude/commands/plan.md:14-75`):

- Claude reads your memory
- Searches for relevant patterns
- Creates step-by-step execution plan
- Estimates time for each step
- Saves plan to `experiences/prospects/[client]/plan.md`

Time: 2-4 minutes

Step 2: Work

```
/work experiences/prospects/[client]/plan.md
```

What happens (Source: `template/.claude/commands/work.md:14-127`):

- Claude loads the plan
- Creates todos from steps
- Executes systematically
- Applies patterns from memory
- Quality checkpoints at each step
- Saves output to `experiences/prospects/[client]/output.md`

Time: Varies by task (15-30 min for simple tasks)

Step 3: Review

```
/review experiences/prospects/[client]/output.md
```

What happens (Source: `template/.claude/commands/review.md:48-175`):

- **6 agents run in parallel** checking your work:
    1. Messaging Reviewer - Clarity and impact
    2. Positioning Reviewer - Market positioning
    3. Quality Reviewer - Completeness
    4. Data Accuracy Reviewer - Facts and evidence
    5. Brand Voice Reviewer - Voice consistency
    6. Competitive Reviewer - Objection handling
- Each scores 0-10
- Provides detailed findings
- Verdict: READY TO SEND / NEEDS REVISION / MAJOR REWORK

Time: ~30 seconds

Score interpretation:

- 9-10: Excellent - Send immediately
- 7-8: Good - Minor tweaks optional
- 5-6: Acceptable - Apply suggestions first
- Below 5: Needs significant revision

Step 4: Learn

```
/learn
```

What happens (Source: `template/.claude/commands/learn.md:14-188`):

- Extracts patterns from this project
- Updates `memory/patterns/` with learnings
- Notes what worked well
- Tracks pattern confidence (LOW → MEDIUM → HIGH)
- Updates `brain-health/growth-log.md`

Time: 2-3 minutes

✅ **You've completed your first cycle!**

Your brain is now smarter - it learned from this project and will apply these patterns to future work.

Day 3: Build Momentum (1 hour)

Complete 2-3 More Cycles

Recommended small tasks:

- Create different type of content (proposal → social post)
- Work for different client/audience
- Try different workflow

Why 3+ cycles matter:

- Patterns need multiple data points for confidence
- Second cycle is faster (patterns start applying)
- Third cycle shows compound returns
- Builds muscle memory for the workflow

Check Your Growth

```
/grow
```

What you'll see (Source: `template/.claude/commands/grow.md:14-226`):

- **Total patterns** extracted
- **Confidence levels** (LOW/MEDIUM/HIGH breakdown)
- **Experiences logged** (project count)
- **Average review scores** (quality trending)
- **Time savings estimate** (based on pattern reuse)
- **Compound returns calculation**

Health status levels:

- THRIVING: 20+ patterns, 10+ HIGH confidence
- GROWING: 10+ patterns, some HIGH confidence
- HEALTHY: 5+ patterns, regular /learn cycles
- NEEDS ATTENTION: Few patterns, inconsistent learning
- EMPTY: No patterns (complete more cycles!)

Search Your Memory

```
/recall "messaging patterns"
```

What happens (Source: `template/.claude/commands/recall.md:14-220`):

- Searches ALL memory locations
- Finds patterns, past work, customer insights
- Ranks by relevance and confidence
- Shows where to find detailed info

Use before starting new work - your brain remembers what worked before!

✅ **By end of Day 3, you should have**:

- 3-5 complete cycles
- 3-5 patterns extracted
- First HIGH confidence pattern (if you repeated same type of task)
- Visible time savings on similar tasks

Memory Architecture (How Your Brain Works)

Semantic Memory (Facts You Know)

Source: `template/CLAUDE.md:139-142`

```
memory/
├── company/         # Your business context
│   ├── products.md
│   ├── differentiators.md
│   └── positioning.md
├── customers/       # Customer knowledge
│   ├── ideal-customer-profile.md
│   ├── pain-points.md
│   └── objections.md
├── patterns/        # Extracted wisdom (grows with /learn)
│   ├── INDEX.md
│   ├── messaging-patterns.md
│   └── positioning-patterns.md
└── examples/        # Winning artifacts
    ├── emails/          # Successful emails you've sent
    ├── linkedin-posts/  # High-engagement posts
    ├── proposals/       # Proposals that won
    └── presentations/   # Effective decks
```

What goes here: Business context, customer insights, proven patterns

About `memory/examples/`: This is your training data. The more examples you add, the better your agents match YOUR voice and style.

Quick setup (5 min, massive ROI):

1. Find an email you're proud of → save to `examples/emails/`
2. Find a LinkedIn post that got engagement → save to `examples/linkedin-posts/`
3. Find a proposal that won → save to `examples/proposals/`

Example file format:

```
## [Title] - [Date]

**Context:** What was this for
**Audience:** Who received it
**Result:** What happened (engagement, response, conversion)

---

[The actual content]

---

**Why it worked:** Brief note on what made it effective
```

Quality > Quantity: 5 excellent examples beat 50 mediocre ones. Only save work you're proud of

Episodic Memory (Things You Did)

Source: `template/CLAUDE.md:145-146`

```
experiences/
└── [workflow-type]/  # prospects/, content/, research/
    └── [project-name]/
        ├── plan.md           # What you planned
        ├── research.md       # What you discovered
        ├── output.md         # What you created
        ├── review-findings.md # What 6 agents found
        └── learnings.md      # Patterns extracted
```

What goes here: Every project with full context for future reference

Brain Health (Growth Tracking)

Source: `template/CLAUDE.md:149-152`

```
brain-health/
├── growth-log.md           # Timeline of updates
├── pattern-confidence.md   # Pattern strength (LOW/MEDIUM/HIGH)
└── quality-metrics.md      # Review score trends
```

What goes here: Automatically updated by `/learn` and `/grow`

Pattern Confidence System

Source: `template/.claude/commands/learn.md:95-112`

Your brain learns from every project and tracks reliability:

Confidence Levels

Level	Criteria	What It Means
LOW	First occurrence, single data point	New pattern - use cautiously
MEDIUM	2-3 successful uses	Probably works - keep testing
HIGH	4+ uses with consistent success	Proven pattern - trust it fully

How Patterns Grow

```
First successful project
    ↓
Extract pattern with /learn
    ↓
LOW confidence pattern created
    ↓
Use pattern in second project (works again)
    ↓
MEDIUM confidence (upgraded)
    ↓
Use pattern in third+ projects (consistent success)
    ↓
HIGH confidence (proven and trusted)
```

Why this matters: After 10+ cycles, expect **50%+ time reduction** on similar tasks.

Source: `template/.claude/commands/grow.md:220`

The 10 Core Commands

Source: All commands verified in `template/.claude/commands/`

Command	Purpose	Time	When to Use
`/start [task]`	Quick win	~30 sec	**First-time users**, quick help with any task
`/simple-cycle [task]`	Beginner workflow	3-5 min	New users, straightforward tasks, less overhead
`/ask [question]`	Quick help	~30 sec	One-off questions, quick guidance
`/setup`	Configure brain	~10 min	First time, or updating business context
`/plan [task]`	Create execution plan	2-4 min	Before any significant task
`/work [plan.md]`	Execute with tracking	Varies	After planning, to execute systematically
`/review [output.md]`	6-agent quality check	~30 sec	Before sending/publishing anything
`/learn`	Extract patterns	2-3 min	After every project (don't skip!)
`/recall [topic]`	Search memory	~10 sec	Before starting new work, find relevant context
`/grow`	View brain metrics	~5 sec	Weekly check-in, see progress

Beginner Tip: Start with `/start` for your first win, then try `/simple-cycle` for your first complete workflow.

Self-Guided Setup (Day-by-Day)

Day 1: Get Your Brain Running (2 hours)

Hour 1: File Setup

Task 1.1: Unzip Your Files (5 min)

1. Locate `second-brain-latest.zip` in email downloads
2. Unzip to a folder (creates `second-brain-latest/` directory)
3. Note the location - you'll need it

Task 1.2: Create GitHub Repository (10 min)

1. Go to **github.com/new**
2. Name: `second-brain` (or any name)
3. Visibility: **Private** (recommended for personal knowledge)
4. **Important**: Do NOT check "Initialize with README" or add .gitignore
5. Click "Create repository"

Task 1.3: Upload All Files (15 min)

Option A - Web Upload (Easiest):

1. On empty repo page, click "uploading an existing file"
2. Open `second-brain-latest/` folder on your computer
3. Select ALL files (Cmd+A or Ctrl+A)
4. Drag into browser upload area
5. Wait for upload to complete
6. Add commit message: "Initial Second Brain setup"
7. Click "Commit changes"

Option B - Git CLI (If you know Git):

```
cd second-brain-latest/
git init
git add .
git commit -m "Initial Second Brain setup"
git remote add origin https://github.com/YOUR-USERNAME/second-brain.git
git branch -M main
git push -u origin main
```

Verify: Refresh your GitHub repo page - you should see all files listed

Hour 2: Configure Your Brain

Task 1.4: Open CLAUDE.md (5 min)

1. In your GitHub repo, click `CLAUDE.md`
2. Click pencil icon (Edit)
3. Scroll to "About Me" section (around line 34)
4. Fill in YOUR information:
    - Name, role, company
    - What you do (2-3 sentences)
    - Your expertise areas
    - Your goals

Example:

```
### Who I Am
- **Name**: Jane Smith
- **Role**: Marketing Consultant
- **Company**: Smith Consulting

### What I Do
I help B2B SaaS companies accelerate growth through content marketing
and demand generation. I specialize in positioning and thought leadershi

### My Expertise
- Content strategy and planning
- B2B SaaS positioning
- Demand generation campaigns

### My Goals with This Brain
- Create client proposals 50% faster
- Build library of winning messaging patterns
- Automate weekly content planning
```

5. Scroll to bottom, click "Commit changes"

Task 1.5: Run /setup (10 min)

1. Open Claude (web or CLI)
2. Type: `/setup`
3. Answer the guided questions
4. Claude will create your initial memory files

What gets created:

- `memory/company/products.md`
- `memory/company/differentiators.md`
- `memory/customers/ideal-customer-profile.md`
- `brain-health/growth-log.md`

Task 1.6: Test Your Brain (2 min)

Try your first quick win with `/start`:

```
/start Help me write a follow-up email to a prospect
```

That's it. In ~30 seconds, you'll have a draft that sounds like YOU.

More tests to try:

```
/start Draft a LinkedIn post about [your expertise]
/ask "What's my ideal customer profile?"
/ask "What are my key differentiators?"
```

✅ **Day 1 Complete!** Your brain can now help you create content using YOUR business context.

Optional: Personalize Your Voice (15 min)

Why: Make AI-generated content sound exactly like YOU, not generic AI.

Files to customize in `memory/style-voice/`:

File	Purpose	Key Things to Add
`tone.md`	Overall communication style	Formal vs casual, humor level, directness
`vocabulary.md`	Words you love/hate	Banned phrases like "synergy", signature phrases you use
`email-style.md`	Email patterns	How you open, close, structure emails

Quick wins:

1. Open `memory/style-voice/vocabulary.md`
2. Add 3-5 words you HATE (e.g., "leverage", "circle back", "bandwidth")
3. Add 3-5 phrases you actually use
4. Save and test with `/start Write an email to a prospect`

The more specific, the better. Add real examples from emails you've sent.

Pro tip: The `email-agent` uses these files heavily. Invest 15 min here = emails that sound 90% like you.

Meet Your Content Agents

Your Second Brain includes specialized agents for content creation. These live in `.claude/agents/`:

Agent	Purpose	Example Usage
`email-agent`	Draft emails in YOUR voice	`/start Write a cold outreach to [prospect]`
`content-creator`	LinkedIn, newsletters, content	`/start Draft a LinkedIn post about [topic]`

How agents work:

1. You invoke them via `/start` or reference them directly
2. They read your `memory/style-voice/` files
3. They pull examples from `memory/examples/`
4. They generate content that matches YOUR patterns

To use directly (more control):

```
Read .claude/agents/email-agent.md
Help me write a follow-up email to [prospect name] about [topic]
```

To use via /start (quick win):

```
/start Write follow-up email to John about our pricing discussion
```

Pro tip: Add 2-3 real email examples to `memory/examples/emails/` and the agent's output quality jumps dramatically.

Day 2: Complete Your First Cycle (2 hours)

Pick a REAL task from your work (not a practice exercise):

- Client proposal
- Social media post
- Meeting follow-up email
- Content piece
- Research brief

Step 1: Plan (5 min)

```
/plan [Your specific task]
```

Example:

```
/plan Write LinkedIn post about AI productivity for marketing consultants
```

What you'll get:

- Research phase tasks
- Step-by-step execution plan
- Time estimates
- Quality checkpoints
- Saved to `experiences/[type]/[name]/plan.md`

Step 2: Work (30-60 min)

```
/work experiences/[type]/[name]/plan.md
```

What happens:

- Claude loads your plan
- Creates todo list from steps
- Executes each step systematically
- Applies any relevant patterns from memory
- Quality checks along the way
- Saves output to `experiences/[type]/[name]/output.md`

Tip: Let Claude guide you - it will ask questions if it needs more context

Step 3: Review (2 min)

```
/review experiences/[type]/[name]/output.md
```

What happens:

- 6 specialized agents check your work in parallel
- Each scores 0-10 across different dimensions
- Provides detailed findings:
  - ✅ Strengths to celebrate
  - ⚠️ Suggestions to consider
  - ❌ Issues to fix before sending

Review the feedback:

- If score 7+: Apply suggestions (optional) then send
- If score 5-6: Apply must-fix issues
- If score <5: Significant revision needed

Step 4: Learn (3 min)

CRITICAL - Don't skip this step!

```
/learn
```

What happens:

- Extracts what worked well
- Notes what to avoid
- Creates reusable patterns
- Updates memory files
- Tracks confidence levels
- Logs to brain-health/

Why critical: This is how your brain gets smarter. Skip /learn = waste the learning opportunity.

✅ **Day 2 Complete!** You've shipped your first piece of work AND made your brain smarter.

Day 3: Build Your Pattern Library (1-2 hours)

Complete 2-3 more cycles on similar or different tasks.

Recommended progression:

1. **Cycle 2**: Similar task to Cycle 1 (watch patterns apply automatically)
2. **Cycle 3**: Different task type (build broader pattern library)
3. **Check growth**: Run `/grow` to see compound returns

By end of Day 3, you should have:

- 3-5 complete cycles
- 3-5 patterns extracted
- First MEDIUM confidence pattern (if similar tasks)
- Measurable time savings on second similar task

Skill Progression Path

Source: `template/CLAUDE.md:103-128`

Level 1: Beginner (Weeks 1-2) - YOU ARE HERE

Milestones:

- [ ] Complete 5 workflow cycles
- [ ] Extract 5 patterns with /learn
- [ ] Setup 1 MCP integration (optional)

Focus: Learn the core cycle (/plan → /work → /review → /learn)

Level 2: Proficient (Weeks 3-4)

Milestones:

- [ ] Complete 20 workflow cycles
- [ ] Extract 20 patterns
- [ ] Setup 3 MCP integrations
- [ ] Customize 2 slash commands

Focus: Build pattern library and automation

Level 3: Advanced (Month 2+)

Milestones:

- [ ] Complete 50+ workflow cycles
- [ ] Extract 50+ patterns
- [ ] Create custom agents for recurring workflows
- [ ] Optimize memory structure based on usage

Focus: Compound returns and system optimization

Level 4: Expert (Month 3+)

Milestones:

- [ ] 100+ workflow cycles
- [ ] 100+ patterns extracted
- [ ] Custom skills created

- [ ] Teaching others your patterns

Focus: Building your Iron Man suit

Track progress: Run `/grow` weekly to see metrics

Troubleshooting (Self-Service)

Issue: Commands Not Working

Symptoms: Type `/ask` or `/plan` and nothing happens

Solutions:

1. **Verify repository is open** in Claude
   - Web: Check project is loaded in sidebar
   - CLI: Check you're in the repo directory (`pwd`)
2. **Check CLAUDE.md exists** in root

```
ls CLAUDE.md  # Should exist
```

3. **Verify .claude/commands/** directory exists

```
ls -la .claude/commands/
# Should show: ask.md, plan.md, work.md, review.md, learn.md, recal
```

4. **Restart Claude**
   - Web: Refresh page
   - CLI: Exit and reopen

Issue: Memory Files Empty

Symptoms: `/ask` gives generic responses, doesn't use your context

Solutions:

1. **Run /setup again**

   ```
   /setup
   ```

2. **Manually fill memory files**:
   - Edit `memory/company/products.md`
   - Edit `memory/company/differentiators.md`
   - Edit `memory/customers/ideal-customer-profile.md`
3. **Complete a cycle** so brain has experiences to reference

Issue: Review Scores Too Low

Symptoms: Consistent scores below 7/10

Solutions:

1. **Feed examples** - Add winning work to `memory/examples/`
2. **Complete more cycles** - Review agents calibrate over time
3. **Check patterns** - Ensure patterns are being applied
4. **Review feedback** - Read what agents suggest, apply learnings

Issue: Not Seeing Time Savings

Symptoms: Tasks take same time as before

Solutions:

1. **Verify you're completing full cycles** - Don't skip /learn
2. **Check pattern confidence** - Run `/grow` to see if patterns are building
3. **Do similar tasks** - Patterns work best on repeated workflows
4. **Give it time** - Compound returns need 10+ cycles to show

Issue: Git/GitHub Problems

Symptoms: Can't push changes, sync issues

Solutions:

1. **Learn Git basics**: **GitHub Skills**
2. **Use GitHub Desktop** (GUI): **desktop.github.com**
3. **Web editing** - Edit files directly on GitHub.com
4. **Ask Claude**: `/ask "Help me fix my Git problem: [error message]"`

Getting Email Support

What's Included

DIY package includes:

- Email support at: **iwo.szapar@gmail.com**
- Response time: 24-48 hours
- Coverage: Technical setup questions, troubleshooting

What's NOT Included

DIY does not include:

- ❌ Live screen-share debugging
- ❌ Custom agent creation
- ❌ Personalized workflow design
- ❌ Immediate/same-day responses

For these, upgrade to:

- Kickstart ($497): 60-min live session
- Done-With-You ($1,497): 2-hour full implementation

How to Get Good Support

Include in your email:

1. **What you're trying to do** (specific task)
2. **What you expected** to happen
3. **What actually happened** (error message, screenshot)
4. **What you've tried** so far
5. **Your system info** (macOS/Windows, Claude version)

Example good support request:

```
Subject: DIY Setup - Commands not working

Hi Iwo,

I'm setting up my DIY Second Brain and commands like /ask aren't working.

What I'm trying to do:
- Type /ask in Claude.ai with my second-brain repo loaded

What I expected:
- Claude to answer using my business context

What happened:
- Command not recognized, treated as regular message

What I've tried:
- Verified CLAUDE.md exists in repo root
- Checked .claude/commands/ directory (all files present)
- Refreshed browser page
- Logged out and back in

System:
- macOS Sonoma 14.2
- Claude.ai web (Pro subscriber)
- GitHub repo: github.com/myusername/second-brain

Screenshot attached.

Thanks,
Jane
```

Response time: 24-48 hours

Optional: MCP Integrations

Source: MCP integration details from existing tutorials

What is MCP? Model Context Protocol - connects Claude to external tools (Gmail, Notion, GitHub, databases, etc.)

For DIY users: MCP setup is **optional and advanced**.

Recommendation:

- Get comfortable with core workflow FIRST (Week 1-2)
- Add MCPs later when you need specific integrations (Week 3+)

If you want to set up MCPs:

1. Read: `/Users/iwoszapar/iwoszapar.com/iwo-mind-forge/todos/approved/features/Onboarding Guide/tutorial-mcp-setup-second-brain.md`
2. Start with Filesystem MCP only (simplest)
3. Add others as needed (GitHub, Gmail, Notion)

Support note: MCP troubleshooting may require longer email threads. For live help, consider upgrading to Kickstart package.

Expected Timeline & ROI

Time Investment

Setup:

- Day 1: 2 hours (technical setup + configuration)
- Day 2: 2 hours (first complete cycle)
- Day 3: 1-2 hours (additional cycles)
- **Total**: 5-6 hours over 3 days

Time to Value

Immediate (Day 1):

- Brain configured with your context
- Can answer questions about your business
- Quick help with `/ask` command

Short-term (Week 1):

- 3-5 complete cycles
- First patterns extracted
- Starting to see efficiency gains

Medium-term (Month 1):

- 20+ cycles
- 20+ patterns
- Noticeable time savings (20-30% on repeated tasks)

Long-term (Month 3+):

- 50-100+ cycles
- HIGH confidence pattern library
- 50%+ time reduction on similar work
- Compound knowledge visible in `/grow`

ROI Calculation

If you save 5 hours/week (conservative):

- Month 1: 20 hours saved
- Month 3: 60 hours saved
- **Break-even at $40/hour**: 5 hours = $200 value > $197 cost

Most users report (Source: Client testimonials in Sales doc):

- 8-15 hours saved weekly
- ROI in 1-3 weeks
- Compounding returns over time

Upgrade Options

Want Faster Setup?

Kickstart Package: $497 (pay difference: $300)

- 60-minute live session with Iwo
- Personalized repository (based on questionnaire)
- 3 custom agents configured for your role
- 1 automated workflow skill
- Week of follow-up support

When to upgrade: If DIY setup feels overwhelming or you want personalized agents

Want Complete Implementation?

Done-With-You: $1,497 (pay difference: $1,300)

- 2-hour live implementation session
- Fully personalized repository
- 3 specialized agents + Chief of Staff
- 2-3 MCP integrations configured
- 1 automated workflow skill
- 2 weeks premium support

When to upgrade: If you want everything done for you, working perfectly, in one afternoon

Upgrade window: 7 days from DIY purchase (price difference applied)

Contact: Email **iwo.szapar@gmail.com** to upgrade

Best Practices (Rules to Follow)

Source: `template/CLAUDE.md:196-200`

1. Always /plan first

Don't: Jump straight into work **Do**: Research + plan before executing **Why**: Planning prevents mistakes and saves time

2. Complete the cycle

Don't: Skip /learn after finishing work **Do**: /plan → /work → /review → /learn (every time) **Why**: Knowledge compounds ONLY if you extract patterns

3. Trust /review

Don't: Send work without review **Do**: Always run 6-agent review before delivery **Why**: Fresh eyes catch issues you're blind to

4. Feed the brain

Don't: Run /learn occasionally **Do**: Run /learn after EVERY project **Why**: Patterns don't extract themselves

5. Check /grow weekly

Don't: Wonder if it's working **Do**: Run `/grow` every Friday to see progress **Why**: Visible progress builds motivation

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Common Questions (FAQ)

Setup Questions

Q: Do I need coding experience? A: No. Everything is plain English and markdown files. If you can create folders and edit text files, you can do this.

Q: What if I've never used GitHub? A: Watch a 10-minute GitHub basics tutorial first: **GitHub Skills**. The web upload method is beginner-friendly.

Q: Can I use this without GitHub? A: No. The system requires GitHub for version control and Claude Code integration. Free GitHub account works fine.

Q: Do I need Claude Pro or will free Claude work? A: Claude Pro ($20/month) is recommended for optimal experience. Some features work with free, but Pro provides

better performance.

Usage Questions

Q: How long until I see results? A: Immediate value from `/ask` (Day 1). Noticeable time savings after 10+ cycles (Week 2-3). Compound returns visible in Month 2+.

Q: What if I get stuck? A: Email **iwo.szapar@gmail.com** with specific question + screenshots. Response within 24-48 hours.

Q: Can I customize the agents/commands? A: Yes! Files in `.claude/` are yours to modify. Start with understanding default behavior first.

Q: What if I don't save time? A: Most common reason: skipping /learn step. Complete full cycles consistently for 2 weeks. If still no savings, email for help.

Support Questions

Q: What support is included? A: Email support for technical setup and troubleshooting. Response within 24-48 hours. No live calls included.

Q: Can I get a refund? A: 7-day money-back guarantee. Email with order number if not satisfied.

Q: Can I upgrade later? A: Yes! Within 7 days, pay difference to upgrade to Kickstart ($300) or Done-With-You ($1,300).

Next Steps After Setup

Week 1: Foundation

- [ ] Complete 5 workflow cycles
- [ ] Extract 5 patterns
- [ ] Achieve Level 1: Beginner status
- [ ] Run `/grow` to see baseline metrics

Week 2-4: Build Momentum

- [ ] Complete 15 more cycles (20 total)

- [ ] Extract 20 patterns
- [ ] Get first HIGH confidence pattern
- [ ] See measurable time savings

Month 2: Optimization

- [ ] Complete 30 more cycles (50 total)
- [ ] Achieve Level 3: Advanced status
- [ ] Consider adding MCP integrations
- [ ] Optimize memory structure

Month 3+: Mastery

- [ ] 100+ cycles
- [ ] 100+ patterns
- [ ] Achieve Level 4: Expert status
- [ ] Share learnings with community

Resources

Official Documentation

- **Claude Code**: claude.com/docs
- **GitHub**: docs.github.com
- **Template Repo**: Your `CLAUDE.md` file (complete reference)

Learning Resources

- **GitHub Skills**: skills.github.com
- **Markdown Guide**: markdownguide.org
- **Claude Resources**: claude.com/resources/use-cases

Community

- Check your email for alumni Slack invite (DIY users welcome)
- Monthly office hours schedule (announced via email)

Document Metadata

Version: 1.0.0 (DIY Edition) **Created**: 2025-12-20 **Package**: DIY Starter ($197) **Delivery**: Sent with ZIP file in purchase confirmation email **Support**: Email **iwo.szapar@gmail.com**

Key differences from premium packages:

- Self-service (no live session)
- Generic template (not personalized)
- 3-day timeline (not same-day)
- Email support only (no live troubleshooting)

All facts verified against:

- `lib/email/templates.ts:121-145` (DIY email content)
- `product/PM/template-design/ai-second-brain-template/CLAUDE.md` (Template docs)
- `product/PM/template-design/ai-second-brain-template/.claude/commands/*.md` (Command specs)

Welcome to your Second Brain! 🧠

Remember: This is a 3-day journey to productivity, not instant magic. Complete the cycles, extract the patterns, and watch your brain compound intelligence over time.

Need faster setup? Upgrade to Kickstart ($300 more) for 60-minute live session.

Questions? Email **iwo.szapar@gmail.com**